

ANIME

Demon Slayer: Kimetsu no Yaiba (Season 1)

★★★★☆ | This one is for folks who're starting out with Anime. The source manga isn't too long and the animation is also up to contemporary standards, so you don't have to force yourself to watch Demon Slayer. Demon Slayer: Kimetsu no Yaiba is centered around Tanjiro Kamado, a young lad forced into playing an adult after the untimely demise of his father. As if circumstances weren't already tough on the lad, he has his soul crushed one day when he returns to his home to discover his entire family slaughtered with just one survivor, his wounded younger sister, Nezuko. Her wounds are found to be the result of a demon attack which unfortunately turns her into one as well. Tanjiro, now fighting his own



demon sister, is saved by a Demon Slayer who had been hunting demons nearby. The demon slayer, about to kill the newly transformed Nezuko when Tanjiro fights to save her. Human emotions can be quite twisted and outright confusing but the Demon Slayer, in a show of sympathy, knocks out Nezuko and puts Tanjiro on a path to becoming a demon

slayer himself with the goal of curing his sister and making her human once again.

We took the pains of reading through the manga and the anime is pretty close to what's in the manga. One could even say that the manga was the storyboard for the anime since scenes from the manga have played out in the anime frame-by-frame. That being said, the pace of the anime is a little fast since the protagonist advances through ridiculously complex training regimes in the blink of an eye. His battles against demons that are monumentally stronger one after the other, make the job of being a demon slayer seem like an easy task. A good example of pacing the story can be Kabaneri of the Iron Fortress where the story tends to take place over the span of a few months and is an equally short anime.

At its heart, Demon Slayer: Kimetsu no Yaiba is another tale that makes use of the vampire concept with little creative liberties on the concept itself but plenty of overexaggerated action that's typical of anime. Don't get us wrong, the anime is certainly done well but it's nothing new.

SERIES

Dota: Dragon's Blood

★★★★☆ | From the studio who made Avatar: The Legend of Korra, comes a new Netflix original animated series, about Dota. Yes, it's an "anime" about Dota. The jury's still out about whether this qualifies as an anime or a cartoon, but for the purposes of this review, we'll just call it an anime.

If you've ever played Dota or are familiar with it at all, then you know that Dota's approach to things has never really been about the lore or the story. We know the heroes, we know their abilities, and for the most part we know that there's some vague reason for them to be doing what they're doing, that's it. Since the game was originally a Warcraft III mod, a lot of their lore was



tied to their in-game models. It wasn't until Dota 2 came about that they became truly individual characters. Yet, we still didn't really see much in the lore department. Dota's biggest competitor on the other hand, League of Legends,

has a universe that's rich in lore for its world and characters, and is constantly evolving and changing – even they've got a Netflix series on the way. Nevertheless, this anime was definitely a pleasant surprise.

If the name didn't give it away, Dragon's Blood tells the tale of Davion, the Dragon Knight who is eventually joined by Mirana, and due to events in the show, they end up travelling together. Throughout the series, you will encounter other characters from the Dota universe, such as Invoker, and Luna, but there are also new faces, which are thankfully fleshed out and not just there for the sake of it. There's a lot of world building that needs to be done and Dragon's Blood is a good start, it does a good job of introducing the Radiant and the Dire. As a bonus, you don't really need to have played Dota to enjoy this show; you can watch this simply expecting a good fantasy show with potential to become much much more.